# Gazetteers

H 1630

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## *A. Background*

A gazetteer is a geographical dictionary in which names of places are given in alphabetical order with location and/or coordinates. In addition, entries sometimes include pronunciation and brief historical information. This instruction sheet provides guidelines for assigning the heading and the subdivision ***--Gazetteers***.

LC practice: As stated in H 1075, LC catalogers will no longer use form subdivisions. Instead assign an appropriate term or terms from Library of Congress Genre/Form Terms (LCGFT), e.g. ***Textbooks***. To replace a form subdivision that includes a demographic group, also assign Library of Congress Demographic Groups Terms (LCDGT) to bring out the audience of the resource being cataloged, e.g. ***German speakers*** or ***Arabic, Students of***.

## *B. Recent revisions*

2026-08: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.

## *C. Definitions*

*Gazetteer*: geographical dictionary in which names of places are given in alphabetical order with location and/or coordinates, sometimes including brief historical information and geographical description.

## *D. General*

Assign the heading ***Gazetteers*** to general geographical dictionaries not limited to a particular place.

Do not use the subdivision ***--Dictionaries*** under the heading ***Gazetteers***.

LC practice: For general gazetteers not limited to a particular place, no subject heading is necessary. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Gazetteers***.

***Example:***

Title: Webster's New geographical dictionary.

650 #0 $a Gazetteers.

*LC practice:*

No subject heading.

655 #7 $a Gazetteers. $2 lcgft

## *E. By place*

Use the free-floating form subdivision ***--Gazetteers*** under names of places for geographical dictionaries of these places.

LC practice: Assign the subject heading(s) for the place. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Gazetteers***.

***Examples:***

Title: Survey gazetteer of the British Isles.

651 #0 $a British Isles $v Gazetteers.

*LC practice:*

651 #0 $a British Isles.

655 #7 $a Gazetteers. $2 lcgft

Title: A gazetteer of New Hampshire, containing descriptions of all the counties, towns, and districts in the state.

651 #0 $a New Hampshire $v Gazetteers.

*LC practice:*

651 #0 $a New Hampshire.

655 #7 $a Gazetteers. $2 lcgft

## *F. Other*

Assign the heading ***Names, Geographical*** to other types of works about place names, such as works that focus on the origin and meaning of geographical names or lists of places not arranged in alphabetical order.

Do not subdivide ***Names, Geographical*** by ***--Dictionaries***.

***Examples:***

```
Title: California place names : the origin and etymology of current
geographical names.
   650 #0 $a Names, Geographical $z California.
   651 #0 $a California $x History, Local.


Title: Geographical names in ancient Indian inscriptions.
   650 #0 $a Names, Geographical $z India.
   650 #0 $a Inscriptions $z India.
   651 #0 $a India $x Historical geography.
```

## *G. MARC 21 coding*

Select code d, Dictionaries for field 008/24-27 (the box labeled Contents on the 008 input screen in the LC ILS) for gazetteers and for works on geographical names in dictionary format.

## *Revision history*

2026-08: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.